

GATE 2027 CS

6-Month Study Plan

Target: 70+ Marks | OBC-NCL | Working Professional (eScan MicroWorld)

Qualification:	B.E. Computer Engineering, Rizvi College University of Mumbai 2020
Category:	OBC-NCL (Hindu Kunbi) — 27% PSU reservation + relaxed age limits
Experience:	4-5 years C++ and Linux Systems Programming at eScan MicroWorld
Strength areas:	OS (Linux expert), Algorithms & DS (C++ expert), Programming in C
Exam dates:	6, 7, 13, 14, 20, 21 February 2027 (IIT Madras)
Registration:	27 Aug – 27 Sep 2026 (no late fee) 5 Oct 2026 (final) gate2027.iitm.ac.in

Min qualify

27 / 100

PSU target

58+ / 100

YOUR TARGET

70+ / 100

GATE score

~870 / 1000

Prepared: 28 August 2026 | Resources: gateoverflow.in | Exam: Feb 2027

SECTION 1 — OVERVIEW | WHAT 70+ MARKS GETS YOU

70+ raw marks out of 100 puts you in the top 1% of all GATE CS candidates — a score that unlocks every major PSU and all IIT M.Tech programs.

Metric	Value at 70+ marks
GATE Score (out of 1000)	~870 / 1000
All India Rank (CS paper)	~700 (top 1% of ~1.5 lakh CS candidates)
Percentile	~99.7 percentile
PSUs shortlisted	ALL 9 — ONGC, IOCL (last chance!), GAIL, BHEL, NTPC, AAI, DRDO, BARC (last chance!), ISRO
M.Tech admission	IIT Bombay, IIT Delhi, IIT Madras, IIT Kharagpur eligible
OBC-NCL minimum to qualify	27 / 100 raw marks (GATE 2026 official). 70 gives you a 43-mark buffer.

Where the 70 Marks Come From

Subject	GATE avg marks	Your target	Your strength
General Aptitude	15 fixed	13–14 / 15	Bank prep = free marks ■
Engineering Mathematics	12–15	10–12	Discrete Maths needs work
Operating Systems	8–10	8–9	Linux/eScan = expert level ■■
Algorithms	10–13	10–12	C++ background ■
Programming & DS	10–12	9–11	4-5 yr C++ at eScan ■
DBMS	6–8	5–7	SQL familiar
Computer Networks	6–8	5–6	Network security exposure
Theory of Computation	6–8	5–6	Hardest — 4 weeks needed
Compiler Design	3–5	3–4	Linked to TOC
Digital Logic + COA	6–10	6–8	Formula-based — fast to learn
TOTAL TARGET	100	70+	Achievable with this plan

Key Insight for 70+ Target

- The gap between 60 and 70 marks is almost entirely in: TOC (4 weeks) + Discrete Maths (4 weeks) + mock volume.
- Your OS + Algorithms + Programming sections carry ~28–34 marks — master these 3 first.
- Multiple working professionals have scored 68–72 marks with 2–3 hrs/day. Consistency > intensity.
- Bank exam General Aptitude prep directly covers GATE GA (15 marks). Zero extra study needed there.

SECTION 2 — SUBJECT-BY-SUBJECT STUDY ORDER (Do NOT jump between subjects)

Complete ALL previous year questions (PYQs) of one subject before starting the next. Each subject in this list builds on the previous one.

Order	Subject	Marks	GO Q count	Weeks	Key GATE topics
1st ■■	Operating Systems	8–10	6,300+	3 wks	CPU scheduling (SJF/RR/MLFQ), Page replacement (LRU/OPT/FIFO numericals), Deadlock (Banker's algorithm), Semaphore/Mutex, Virtual memory & TLB
2nd ■	Algorithms	10–13	5,800+	4 wks	Master theorem (all 3 cases), DP (LCS/LIS/0-1 knapsack/matrix chain/edit distance), Graph (Dijkstra/Bellman-Ford/Floyd-Warshall/Kruskal/Prim), NP-complete reductions
3rd ■	Programming & Data Structures	10–12	7,900+	3 wks	C code output questions (pointers/recursion), BST operations, AVL rotations, Heap (heapify/heapsort), Hashing (chaining vs open addressing), Linked list reversal
4th	Discrete Mathematics	5–8	15,000+	4 wks	Graph theory (Euler/Hamiltonian/coloring/planarity), Combinatorics (pigeonhole/inclusion-exclusion), Logic (resolution/tautology), Relations (partial order/lattice), Recurrences
5th	DBMS	6–8	5,800+	3 wks	Normalisation (1NF→2NF→3NF→BCNF derivation), B+ tree operations, SQL (JOINS/GROUP BY/HAVING/nested), Transaction serializability & 2PL
6th	Computer Networks	6–8	5,800+	3 wks	Sliding window (Go-Back-N vs Selective Repeat numericals), IP subnetting + CIDR (practise subnet calculations), TCP congestion control (AIMD/slow start)
7th ■	Theory of Computation	6–8	7,800+	4 wks	DFA/NFA construction + minimisation, CFG→CNF conversion, PDA design, Turing machine construction, Rice's theorem, Decidability reductions — do NOT skip PDA/TM
8th	Compiler Design	3–5	2,900+	2 wks	FIRST and FOLLOW set computation, LL(1) parse table construction, LR(0)/SLR(1)/LALR(1) items, Syntax-directed translation (SDT)

9th	Digital Logic	3–5	4,500+	2 wks	K-map minimisation (4-variable), JK/D flip-flops, Counters/shift registers, BCD/Gray code conversion, MUX-based circuit design
10th	CO & Architecture	3–5	4,600+	2 wks	Pipelining stall cycles + hazard detection, Cache hit/miss rate numericals, Effective memory access time, Addressing modes (direct/indirect/register)
11th ■	General Aptitude	15 fixed	5,300+	2 wks paralle l	Verbal: RC + sentence completion. Quant: number series, ratio, probability, time-work. Bank exam prep covers 80% of this — minimal extra effort needed

Green = your strongest subjects (start here). Orange = hardest (TOC — do not skip or rush it).

SECTION 3 — MONTH-BY-MONTH PLAN | Sep 2026 – Feb 2027

Dual Exam Strategy — Bank + GATE Together

- Bank exams protected: SBI Prelims 26 Sep, IBPS Prelims 10 Oct, SBI Mains 23 Nov, IBPS Mains 27 Dec.
- GATE is secondary until bank Mains are done (27 Dec 2026). Full GATE focus begins 28 Dec 2026.
- Even 30 min GATE/day during bank months = 26+ hrs/month = real progress on OS + Algorithms.

SEPTEMBER 2026 (Sep 1–30) | 30 days

Bank exam	SBI Clerk Prelims 26 Sep — 90% of study time on bank exam. Reasoning + Quant DI + English. Take 8-10 full bank mocks.
GATE topic	OS Part 1: Process management, CPU scheduling, Deadlock. You know Linux — review, do not re-learn. Browse all OS PYQs at gateoverflow.in/operating-system . Download GO OS PDF from book.gateoverflow.in .
GATE hrs/day	30 min/day (evenings, post-office)
Month target	Solve GATE CS 2022 paper in last week of Sep. Score 40-50/100 is acceptable at this stage.

OCTOBER 2026 (Oct 1–31) | 31 days

Bank exam	IBPS Clerk Prelims 10 Oct. Bank Mains prep starts 12 Oct. 60% bank / 40% GATE from 12 Oct onwards.
GATE topic	Algorithms (Master theorem, sorting, BFS/DFS, Dijkstra, Kruskal, Floyd-Warshall, DP). Programming & DS: C code tracing on GO — these are fast marks for C++ experts. gateoverflow.in/algorithms + gateoverflow.in/programming-in-c
GATE hrs/day	30 min until 10 Oct → 1.5 hrs/day from 12 Oct
Month target	Solve GATE CS 2023 paper. Target 48–55/100. Complete Algorithms PYQs.

NOVEMBER 2026 (Nov 1–30) | 30 days

Bank exam	SBI Clerk Mains 23 Nov — 80% bank until 22 Nov. Post-23 Nov: GATE acceleration starts.
GATE topic	1–22 Nov: DBMS (45 min/day) — ER model, SQL, normalisation (BCNF), B+ trees, transactions. 24–30 Nov: Computer Networks — sliding window numericals, subnetting, TCP congestion. Solve GATE CS 2024 paper on 29 Nov. gateoverflow.in/databases + gateoverflow.in/computer-networks
GATE hrs/day	45 min/day (1–22 Nov) → 3 hrs/day (24–30 Nov)
Month target	Solve GATE CS 2024 paper. Target 53–60/100. SBI Mains 23 Nov — target 100+/200.

DECEMBER 2026 (Dec 1–31) | 31 days

Bank exam	IBPS Clerk Mains 27 Dec. 3 hrs/day GATE. Reduce to 0 hrs on 26–27 Dec only.
GATE topic	TOC (3 weeks): DFA/NFA → CFG/CNF → PDA → Turing Machines → Decidability/Rice's theorem. This is the hardest subject — do NOT skip PDA or TM sections. Use GO Classes YouTube for TOC if needed. Compiler Design (1 week): FIRST/FOLLOW, LL/LR parsing. gateoverflow.in/theory-of-computation + gateoverflow.in/compiler-design
GATE hrs/day	3 hrs/day GATE (1–25 Dec)
Month target	Solve GATE CS 2025 paper. Target 60–65/100. IBPS Mains 27 Dec — target 100+/200.

JANUARY 2027 (Jan 1–31) | 31 days ★ FULL GATE FOCUS ★

Bank exam	No bank exam tasks. 100% GATE. This is your most important month.
GATE topic	Week 1: Digital Logic + COA PYQs (K-map, pipelining, cache numericals). Week 2: General Aptitude PYQs (15 marks — fast with bank prep background). Weeks 3–4: Full syllabus revision, solve GATE 2025 + 2026 full papers, review entire error log notebook. 4 Jan: check GATE city allotment on GOAPS.
GATE hrs/day	4–5 hrs/day
Month target	GATE CS 2026 paper target: 65–70/100 consistently. If yes → you will score 70+ in actual exam.

FEBRUARY 1–5, 2027 | 5 days — Final Sprint

Bank exam	No bank exam tasks.
GATE topic	1–3 Feb: Write one-page formula sheet per subject (Master theorem cases, normalisation rules, FIRST/FOLLOW procedure, sliding window formula, pipelining stall cycle formula). 4 Feb: Review formula sheets only — no full papers. 5 Feb: REST — 8 hrs sleep. Pack bag: Admit card + Aadhaar + 2 photos + water.
GATE hrs/day	2 hrs light revision only (no full mocks)
Month target	Arrive exam centre 45 min early on exam day. Do GA first. OS second. Algorithms third.

SECTION 4 — DAILY & WEEKLY SCHEDULE | Working Professional (eScan full-time)

Designed for 2–3 hrs/day on weekdays and 4–5 hrs on weekends — sustainable for 6 months alongside a full-time job.

Weekday Schedule (Monday – Friday)

Time	Activity	Duration
6:00–6:30 AM	Sep–Dec: 10 vocab words + 5 banking GK items (Oliveboard app). Jan: 1-page formula sheet review per subject.	30 min
Office (lunch)	15 min: Oliveboard daily quiz (Sep–Dec) OR GO topic quiz on mobile (Jan).	15 min
7:00–8:30 PM	Main study: Sep–Oct → Bank (Reasoning/Quant). Nov–Dec → GATE PYQs (DBMS/Networks/TOC/Compiler). Jan → GATE revision + mocks.	90 min
9:00–9:30 PM	Sep–Dec: Current affairs capsule. Jan: Error log review + re-attempt flagged questions.	30 min
Total	Focused, distraction-free. No phone during study slot.	~2.5 hrs

Weekend Schedule (Saturday – Sunday)

Time	Saturday	Sunday
7:00–9:00 AM	Full mock test — 60-min bank prelims (Sep–Oct) OR full GATE paper (Nov onwards). Strict timer, no phone, no breaks.	GATE PYQ marathon — 1 subject, 40 questions timed at 1.5 min each.
10 AM–12 PM	Mock analysis — every wrong answer on GateOverflow. Read all comments.	Banking GK capsule (Sep–Dec) OR Discrete Maths PYQs (Jan).
2:00–4:00 PM	Weak area practice identified from mock analysis.	Error log review — re-attempt flagged questions without looking at solution.
Total	4–5 hrs focused study	4 hrs focused study

Study Time Allocation — Phase by Phase

Phase	Period	Bank %	GATE %	Total hrs/day
Bank Prelims sprint	Sep 1 – Oct 10	90%	10%	2.5
Bank Mains + GATE	Oct 12 – Nov 22	60%	40%	3
GATE acceleration	Nov 24 – Dec 25	20%	80%	3.5
Pure GATE	Dec 28 – Jan 31	0%	100%	4–5

Final revision	Feb 1–5	0%	100% revision only	2
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SECTION 5 — MOCK TEST SCHEDULE & HOW TO ANALYSE THEM

The biggest difference between 60 and 70 scorers is mock test volume + quality of analysis. One well-analysed mock beats five unanalysed ones every time.

Monthly Mock Schedule — GATE CS Previous Year Papers

Month	Paper	GO resource	Target score	Action after
Oct 2026	GATE CS 2022	gateoverflow.in/exams/gate?type=1	45–55 / 100	Find 3 weakest subjects → prioritise in Nov prep
Nov 2026	GATE CS 2023	Official paper + rank.gateoverflow.in	50–58 / 100	Compare with Oct. Track improvement. Are weak subjects better?
Dec 2026	GATE CS 2024	Official paper + rank.gateoverflow.in	55–62 / 100	Deep wrong-answer audit. Read every GO explanation. Update error log.
Jan Wk 2	GATE CS 2025	Official paper + rank.gateoverflow.in	60–68 / 100	If 60+ → on track for 70. Below 55 → emergency: OS+Algo+DS only.
Jan Wk 3	GATE CS 2026	Official paper + rank.gateoverflow.in	65–70 / 100	This score predicts your actual exam result. Final calibration.
Jan Wk 4	GO Full Mock 1	gateoverflow.in/exams/gate?type=1	65–72 / 100	Last full mock. If 65+ consistently → 70+ in actual exam.
Feb 1–5	NO full papers	Formula sheets only	—	Rest. Sleep 8 hrs. Pack exam bag. Arrive 45 min early on exam day.

How to Analyse a Mock Test (Critical — Most People Skip This Step)

Step	What to do
1. Score split	Total score vs target. Section-wise breakdown. Count: careless mistakes vs concept gaps vs unknown topics.
2. Wrong Q audit	Open EVERY wrong answer on gateoverflow.in. Read accepted answer + ALL comments — comments often have better explanations than the accepted answer. Tag each wrong answer: A=careless, B=concept gap, C=never seen.
3. Time analysis	Target: GA 15 min, Engineering Maths 25 min, Technical CS 140 min. If TOC alone took 45 min → you are over-spending on hard questions. Skip and return.
4. Error log	All Type B and C wrong answers → write in physical notebook: subject, concept missed, correct approach. This notebook is your revision bible in January 2027.

**5. Follow-up
practice**

For every topic you got wrong → go to [gateoverflow.in/\[subject\]](https://gateoverflow.in/[subject]) → solve 15 more questions on that specific topic within 2 days of the mock.

SECTION 6 — GATEOVERFLOW LINKS | EXAM DAY STRATEGY

All GateOverflow Links — Bookmark Every One of These

Resource	Direct URL	When & why to use it
Previous Year Questions	gateoverflow.in/previous-years	START HERE for every subject — GATE 2000-2026 sorted by year and subject
OS PYQs (6,300+ Q)	gateoverflow.in/operating-system	Your strongest subject — do first, builds momentum
Algorithms PYQs (5,800+)	gateoverflow.in/algorithms	Highest marks (10-13/yr). Master theorem + DP + graph.
Programming & DS (7,900+)	gateoverflow.in/programming-in-c	C code tracing = fast marks for C++ experts
Discrete Maths (15,000+)	gateoverflow.in/mathematics/discrete-mathematics	Graph theory + combinatorics repeat every year
DBMS PYQs (5,800+)	gateoverflow.in/databases	Normalisation + B+ tree operations most tested
Computer Networks (5,800+)	gateoverflow.in/computer-networks	Sliding window + subnetting numericals — practise heavily
TOC PYQs (7,800+)	gateoverflow.in/theory-of-computation	Hardest subject — 4 weeks minimum. Do not skip PDA/TM.
Compiler Design (2,900+)	gateoverflow.in/compiler-design	FIRST/FOLLOW sets + LR parsing most important
Digital Logic (4,500+)	gateoverflow.in/digital-logic	K-map + flip-flops + counters
CO & Architecture (4,600+)	gateoverflow.in/co-and-architecture	Pipelining + cache numericals — formula based
General Aptitude (5,300+)	gateoverflow.in/general-aptitude	15 marks fixed. Bank prep covers 80% — fast to complete.
GO PDF Books (FREE)	book.gateoverflow.in	Download all subject PDFs. Solve each 3-4 times. Most toppers cite this as #1 resource.
Full Length GATE Exam	gateoverflow.in/exams/gate?type=1	716 papers. Exact GATE interface + calculator. Use from Oct 2026.
Subject-wise GATE Exam	gateoverflow.in/exams/gate?type=3	Targeted practice by subject. Use after finishing each subject's PYQs.
Rank Predictor	rank.gateoverflow.in	Enter mock answers → get estimated GATE score + rank. Use after every full mock.
Marks Distribution	md.gatecse.in	Subject-wise marks per year 2010-2026. Use for study priority decisions.

Topper Blogs	gateoverflow.in/blogs/testimonial	Real strategies from AIR 1-500 toppers. Read 5+ blogs for motivation.
GO Classes (paid)	goclasses.in	Best coaching for TOC + Discrete Maths. YouTube channel also has free content.

Exam Day Strategy — 65 Questions in 180 Minutes

Time window	Section	Strategy
First 15 min	General Aptitude (15 marks)	DO GA FIRST — easiest marks, builds confidence. Bank prep makes this trivial. Target: 13/15 in 15 min. Skip any GA question taking more than 90 seconds.
Next 25 min	Engineering Maths (12-15 marks)	Discrete Maths + Linear Algebra + Probability. Target 10+ marks. Skip any question taking more than 3 min — mark for review and return.
Remaining 140 min	Technical CS (50-60 marks)	ORDER by your strength: OS first (your best) → Algorithms + DS → DBMS → Networks → Digital Logic + COA → TOC → Compiler Design. Never spend more than 4 min on one question.
Throughout	Negative marking (~1/3 per wrong mark)	1-mark wrong: -0.33. 2-mark wrong: -0.67. ONLY attempt if >70% confident. 50-50 guess → SKIP (expected value is negative). Blank = 0 marks. Wrong = penalty. Leave at most 5 questions blank.
For 70+ score	Attempt count target	Attempt 62+ out of 65 questions. Need ~75-80% accuracy. ~47-50 correct out of 62 attempted = 70+ raw marks. Do not rush the easy questions — careless errors kill scores.

8 Mistakes That Kill GATE Scores — Every One Documented by GateOverflow Toppers

X Starting with textbooks instead of PYQs	Reading Tanenbaum OS from Chapter 1 before seeing GATE PYQs is the #1 time waster. FIX: Browse 30 PYQs of any subject BEFORE opening any book. GATE tests specific things.
X Skipping TOC because it is hard	TOC = 6-8 marks. Skipping it loses exactly the marks between 62 and 70. FIX: 4 dedicated weeks. Use GO Classes YouTube TOC playlist. Do not skip PDA or TM.
X Taking mocks without analysing them	Five unanalysed mocks = wasted time. One well-analysed mock = real improvement. FIX: Spend 2x the exam time reading GO explanations for every wrong answer.
X Ignoring Discrete Mathematics	CS students often skip Maths thinking it is theoretical. GATE Discrete Maths is highly applied. FIX: Solve all graph theory + combinatorics PYQs on GO — these repeat every year.
X Not practising C code-tracing questions	GATE gives 3-5 code-output questions every year — all solvable for C++ experts. FIX: gateoverflow.in/programming-in-c → solve all code-output PYQs from 2015-2026.
X Studying new topics in the final 2 weeks	New subjects before GATE displace confidence in what you already know. FIX: No new topics after 1 Feb 2027. Revision + formula sheets only.
X Confusing raw marks with GATE score	65 raw marks is NOT 650 GATE score. Normalisation boosts: 68 raw marks → 811-818 GATE score (real toppers). FIX: Always use rank.gateoverflow.in after every mock to see your actual estimated score.
X Not reading GO comments on wrong answers	The accepted GO answer may have errors. Comments with 50+ upvotes often have better solutions. FIX: Read ALL comments for every question you get wrong — insights are in the community discussion.

After GATE 2027 — PSU Application Timeline

Date	Event	Action
19 Mar 2027	GATE 2027 result + scorecard	Login to GOAPS → download scorecard PDF (needed for ALL PSU applications)
Mar 2027	SBI/IBPS Clerk allotment	Join bank job. You CAN still attend PSU interviews even after joining.
Mar–Apr 2027	BHEL ET 2027 notification	bhel.com → Apply immediately
Apr–May 2027	ONGC + NTPC notifications	ongcindia.com + ntpcareers.net → GATE score required

Apr–May 2027	IOCL 2027 — ■ LAST CHANCE	iocl.com → FREE to apply → Apply on Day 1. Your age expires in the 2028 cycle!
Apr–Jun 2027	GAIL ET 2027	gailonline.com → GATE + GD + PI
Jun–Jul 2027	AAI JE IT + DRDO Scientist-B	aai.aero + rac.gov.in → GATE score shortlisting
Jul–Sep 2027	All PSU GD + PI rounds	Your C++ + Linux + Cybersecurity (eScan) experience is your differentiator in every PI.
Sep–Dec 2027	PSU final selections + offers	ONGC/IOCL/GAIL: ~15-18 LPA. NTPC/BHEL: ~10-13 LPA. Bank backup: ~5.5-7 LPA.

Pre-Study Checklist — Tick Before You Begin

- GATE 2027 registered + ■2,000 fee paid at gate2027.iitm.ac.in by 27 Sep 2026
- DigiLocker set up at digilocker.gov.in — Aadhaar linked, B.E. degree uploaded
- GO PDF Books downloaded for ALL subjects from book.gateoverflow.in
- Physical error log notebook ready — dedicated only to GATE wrong answers
- gateoverflow.in and rank.gateoverflow.in bookmarked on laptop browser
- GATE CS 2020, 2021, 2022, 2023, 2024, 2025, 2026 official papers downloaded
- Bank exams applied: IBPS Clerk (21 Aug), SBI Special Drive (27 Aug), SBI Main (31 Aug)
- Weakest subject identified — GO Classes YouTube queued for TOC / Discrete Maths
- Goal written and placed on study desk: "GATE 2027 CS — 70+ marks — PSU 2027"